

IPCC and UNFCCC

Module 5 Lecture 2

The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change

- The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) is the United Nations body for assessing the science related to climate change.
- Created by the United Nations Environment Programme (UN Environment) and the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) in 1988
- The IPCC has 195 Member countries.
- The IPCC was created to provide policymakers with regular scientific assessments on climate change, its implications and potential future risks, as well as to put forward adaptation and mitigation options.

Activities of IPCC

- The main activity of the IPCC is the preparation of reports assessing the state of knowledge of climate change
- It organizes expert meetings and workshops on various topics to support its work programme, and publishes the proceedings of these meetings.
- Outreach activities and communication of its findings
- <https://www.ipcc.ch/>

United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change

- The UNFCCC entered into force on 21 March 1994
- The 198 countries that have ratified the Convention are called Parties to the Convention.
- The ultimate objective of the Convention is to stabilize greenhouse gas concentrations "at a level that would prevent dangerous anthropogenic (human induced) interference with the climate system. Such a level should be achieved within a time-frame sufficient to allow ecosystems to adapt naturally to climate change, to ensure that food production is not threatened, and to enable economic development to proceed in a sustainable manner

United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change

- Industrialized countries are expected to do the most to cut emissions on home ground. They are called Annex I countries and belong to the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD)
- Annex I countries were expected by the year 2000 to reduce emissions to 1990 levels.
- Developing countries (Non-Annex I Parties) report in more general terms on their actions both to address climate change and to adapt to its impacts - but less regularly than Annex I Parties do, and their reporting is contingent on their getting funding for the preparation of the reports, particularly in the case of the Least Developed Countries.
- Government representatives from around the world have gathered nearly every year since 1995 at the UNFCCC Conference of the Parties (COP) to advance work on negotiating multilateral agreements and to provide a way forward in the fight against the significant challenges of climate change.

Global Climate Agreements

- <https://unfccc.int/process-and-meetings/the-paris-agreement>
- https://unfccc.int/kyoto_protocol

United Nations Climate Change Conferences

- These conferences are the foremost global forums for multilateral discussion of climate change matters
- The conferences, which rotate annually among the five United Nations regional groups, serve as the formal meetings of the Conference of the Parties (COP), the Conference of the Parties serving as the meeting of the Parties to the Kyoto Protocol(CMP) and the Conference of the Parties serving as the meeting of the Parties to the Paris Agreement (the CMA).
- The Conference of the Parties – meeting as COP, CMP and CMA – serves two main purposes:
 - To review the implementation of the Convention, the Kyoto Protocol and the Paris Agreement, respectively; and
 - To adopt decisions to further develop and implement these three instruments.

Conference of the Parties (COP)

- The COP is the supreme decision-making body of the Convention. All States that are Parties to the Convention are represented at the COP, at which they review the implementation of the Convention and any other legal instruments that the COP adopts and take decisions necessary to promote the effective implementation of the Convention, including institutional and administrative arrangements.
- A key task for the COP is to review the national communications and emission inventories submitted by Parties. Based on this information, the COP assesses the effects of the measures taken by Parties and the progress made in achieving the ultimate objective of the Convention.